

92% excellent bathing water

A public claim, tested against EEA season data

THE CLAIM

“92% of Maltese bathing waters are of excellent quality.”

European Commission, EIR 2025: Malta

The 92% result matches 80 of 87 sites in the 2023 season.

It is accurate for 2023; the report does not state the reference year beside the figure.

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

*Right for 2023;
date the figure.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

80 / 87

Excellent in 2023

The EEA result rounds to 92%, matching the Commission's statement.

80 / 87

Excellent in 2024

The share remained 92%; 2,107 samples were reported.

77 / 87

Excellent in 2025

The latest season was 88.5%, lower than the quoted 92%.

2 tests

What 'excellent' measures

E. coli and intestinal enterococci under the Bathing Water Directive.

B08 / B09

Balluta Bay, 2024

A temporary warning affected two sites; it does not change the 2023 national classification.

FAIR TO SAY

The 92% statistic is accurate for the 2023 season. Short-term pollution warnings and wastewater treatment failures deserve attention, but they measure different things.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ State the season year beside the 92% figure.

☐ Use the latest EEA result when describing current conditions.

☐ Explain that classification uses two microbiological indicators.

☐ Keep local warnings distinct from national multi-year results.